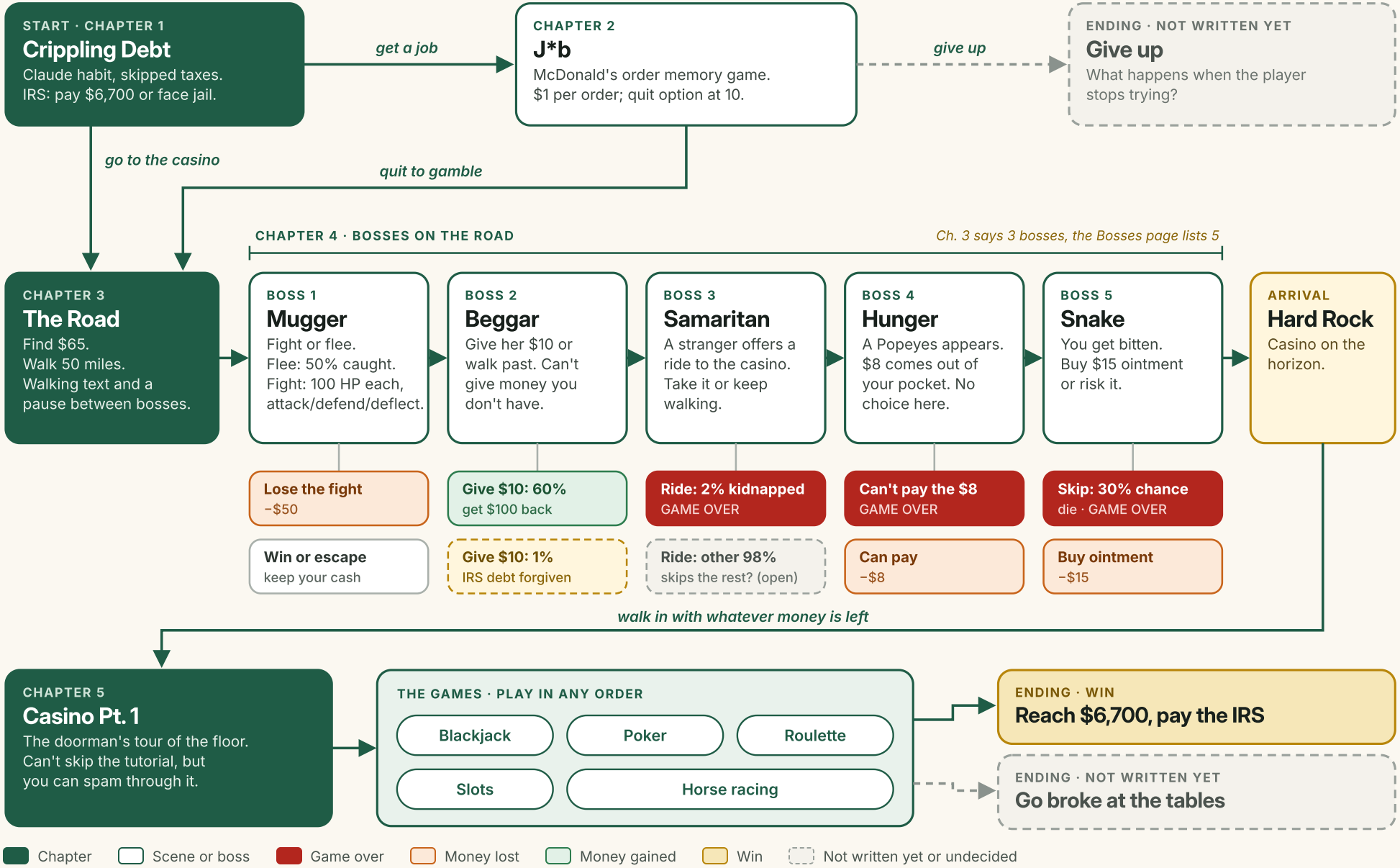
Story Map

The story of a man who owes the IRS $6,700 · AP Computer Science A choose-your-own-adventure by Rob

Snapshot of `docs/story/` (Oct 23, 2026)
Theme: gambling



Chapter by chapter

What happens, what the player decides, and where the money goes. Chapter 4 (the bosses) has its own page.

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1 Crippling Debt

DRAFTED

You're a broke college student who blew everything on Claude tokens, then stopped paying taxes to keep the habit going. The IRS gets in touch with a simple demand: pay $6,700 or face criminal charges and possibly jail.

CHOICE	Get a job (Chapter 2) or go straight to the casino (Chapter 3).
MONEY	You owe $6,700 and have nothing.
CODE	`Ch1.java` prints the intro. The job/casino choice isn't built yet.
OPEN	Call or email? The code adds a 30-day deadline the story page doesn't have.

2 J*b

DRAFTED

You apply to McDonald's and start flipping patties. A memory game makes you remember each customer's order, and every served order pays $1. After ten orders you're offered the chance to quit or keep going, and it sinks in that $1 at a time will never cover the IRS.

CHOICE	Give up (ending not written) or quit and head to the casino (Chapter 3).
MONEY	+$1 per order. Paying the IRS this way takes 6,700 orders.
CODE	`Ch2.java` has the order prompt and the ten-order check, but no loop yet.
OPEN	The give-up ending, and how the memory game decides whether you get paid.

3 On the Way to the Casino

DRAFTED

You find $65 and set off on a 50-mile walk to the Hard Rock Casino. Bosses block the road one after another, with some walking text and maybe a 10-second pause between them. After the last one, the casino shows up on the horizon.

CHOICE	Made inside each boss encounter (next page).
MONEY	Start with $65. Arrive with anywhere from $0 to $132.
CODE	Not started. Planned as `RoadToCasino.java`.
OPEN	Three bosses or five, and what happens if the $65 runs out.

5 Casino Pt. 1

STARTED

The doorman greets you and walks you through a tutorial tour of the casino. You can't skip it, but you can spam through it. Then the floor is yours: blackjack, poker, roulette, slots and horse racing, in whatever order you like.

CHOICE	Which game to play next, and how much to bet.
MONEY	Win by reaching $6,700. No losing condition yet.
CODE	Not started. Each game is planned as its own class in `minigames/`.
OPEN	How you lose here, and whether a Pt. 2 follows.

Every ending so far

Pay the IRS
Reach $6,700 at the casino.

Debt forgiven
The beggar's 1% miracle, if it ends the story.

Kidnapped
2% of Samaritan rides.

Starved
No $8 for Popeyes.

Snakebite
30% if you skip the ointment.

Give up
Chapter 2. Not written yet.

Go broke
Chapter 5. Not written yet.

Chapter 4: the road and its bosses

Five encounters between the player and the casino door, in the order the Bosses page lists them.

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BOSS	THE CHOICE	HOW IT PLAYS OUT	MONEY	CAN IT END THE GAME?
1 · Mugger	Fight, or flee	Fleeing has a 50% chance of getting caught and forced to fight. The fight is turn-based, 100 HP each: attack (no cooldown), defend (1-turn cooldown), deflect (2-turn cooldown). The mugger has the same moves.	**Lose: −$50**	The Bosses page says no, you just lose $50. The story overview lists it as a game over.
2 · Beggar	Give a sweet old lady $10, or leave	Giving pays off 60% of the time with a $100 prize. A 1% chance wipes out the IRS debt. They can't both happen, and you can't give money you don't have.	**−$10, maybe +$100**	Only in a good way, if debt forgiveness ends the story.
3 · Samaritan	Take a ride to the casino, or keep walking	2% of rides end in a kidnapping. What the other 98% does isn't written yet.	None	**Yes: kidnapped**
4 · Hunger	None	You pass a Popeyes and can't resist the fried chicken.	**−$8**	**Yes, if you can't pay**
5 · Snake	Buy ointment, or skip it	Skipping the ointment means a 30% chance of dying from the bite.	**Ointment: −$15**	**Yes, 30% if you skip**

What $65 actually buys on the road

Best run ARRIVES WITH $132

Start	Beat the mugger	Give $10, win $100	Popeyes	Ointment
$65	$65	$155	$147	$132

Careful run ARRIVES WITH $42

Start	Beat the mugger	Walk past beggar	Popeyes	Ointment
$65	$65	$65	$57	$42

Rough run FORCED GAMBLE

Start	Lose to mugger	Walk past beggar	Popeyes	Can't afford ointment
$65	$15	$15	$7	30% death roll

Worst run DEAD AT BOSS 4

Start	Lose to mugger	Give $10, no prize	Popeyes needs $8
$65	$15	$5	GAME OVER

One lost fight leaves exactly $15, the price of the ointment. Popeyes then takes $8 of it without asking, so the snake becomes a forced 30% death roll. If that's a deliberate trap, it's a good one. If not, putting Hunger after the Snake or lowering the mugger's take would give the player a fair shot.

Even the best possible run reaches the casino with $132, so the games have to grow the player's money about 50 times to hit $6,700 (160 times from the careful run's $42). That's worth keeping in mind when you set payouts.

If the Samaritan's ride really drives you to the casino, accepting it skips Hunger and the Snake. A 2% risk to dodge $23 in costs and a 30% death roll is a great deal for the player.

Loose ends

What's still undecided, where the code and the story pages disagree, and where your learning goals fit.

Snapshot of `docs/story/` (Oct 23, 2026)
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Open questions

CHAPTER 1

- The Crippling Debt tab in the Google Doc ends with a stray "I". Typo, or a sentence that got cut off?

CHAPTER 2

- What happens if the player chooses to give up? It needs an ending.
- How does the memory game fit with typing "Serve order"? Does the order have to be right before the $1 pays out?
- If the player keeps working after ten orders, when does the job end?
- Is quitting after ten orders the same as heading to the casino, or a separate choice from giving up?

CHAPTERS 3 AND 4

- 3 bosses or all 5? If 3, are they picked at random?
- Is the 10-second gap between bosses a real wait or a pause in the text?
- What happens if the $65 runs out before the casino?
- Is losing to the mugger a game over or just −$50? NEW
- What does the Samaritan's ride do the 98% of the time you aren't kidnapped? NEW
- Does the 1% debt forgiveness end the game on the spot? NEW

CHAPTER 5 AND BEYOND

- How do you lose at the casino? Hitting $0, a turn limit, the 30-day deadline? NEW
- "Casino Pt. 1" suggests a Pt. 2. What happens after you win? NEW

Story pages vs. the code

- The story page has the IRS **call**. `Ch1.java` has them send an **email** with a 30-day deadline. The deadline is a nice addition worth copying into the story.
- `Ch1.java` sends the player straight to McDonald's. The story gives them a job-or-casino choice first.
- `Ch2.java` asks for "take order". The story page says "Serve order".
- The code has a customer order 600 water cups, which isn't on the story page yet.
- `src/chapters/README.md` plans `CripplingDebt.java` and `Job.java`; the real files are `Ch1.java` and `Ch2.java`.

Your learning list, matched to scenes

Delayed output	The walk between bosses, and the slot reels spinning.
Chance	Flee (50%), Beggar (60% and 1%), Samaritan (2%), Snake (30%), roulette, slots and horse racing.
Cards	Blackjack and poker hands drawn in text.
Colored text	Red for GAME OVER, green for money gained, gold for the win.
Text pictures	The Hard Rock sign appearing on the horizon, the snake, a slot machine.

GITHUB REPOSITORY
`github.com/wafflekraken/compsci-choose-your-own-adventure`

Story pages live in docs/story/
Java code lives in src/